

RE02

Agriculture and Allied Sector of Rajasthan

Rajasthan Economy runs at 11-15 questions a paper and agriculture supplies 3-4 of them. The National Research Centres located in Rajasthan are a documented repeat - 2016, 2018 and 2023. Crop ranks were asked in 2021. Crop-to-district and institute-to-location matching appears in almost every paper.

Rajasthan is a desert state that happens to be India's number one in more crops than any other state - bajra, mustard, guar, moth, isabgol, coriander, fenugreek, henna, taramira and total oilseeds. This chapter is that list, plus the districts those crops come from, plus the research institutes that breed them. It is almost entirely matching and ranking, which means it is learnable in one sitting and revisable in ten minutes.

Rajasthan Agriculture & Allied

Weight in the economy

- 25.7% of GSDVA (Econ Review 2025-26)
- Largest employer of the workforce
- Foodgrains 283.98 lakh tonnes (2025-26)
- Average holding 2.73 hectares
- Agriculture budget Rs 1.19 lakh cr

Land & water

- Net sown area 53.10% of reporting area
- Cropping intensity 152.19 (2023-24)
- Ten agro-climatic zones, IA to V
- Wells and tube-wells - largest irrigation source
- IGNP - the largest canal system

Rank 1 in India

- Bajra ~39%
- Mustard ~47%
- Guar ~87%
- Total oilseeds ~22%
- Moth, isabgol, coriander
- Fenugreek, henna, taramira
- Wool ~47.85%

Rank 2 and 3

- Groundnut 2nd (after Gujarat)
- Soybean 3rd (after MP, Maharashtra)
- Milk 2nd (after Uttar Pradesh)

Crop-place map

- Sojat (Pali) - henna capital
- Ramganj Mandi (Kota) - coriander
- Mathania (Jodhpur) - red chilli
- Nagauri methi; Jhalawar oranges
- Chittorgarh & Pratapgarh - opium

Research institutes

- CAZRI Jodhpur 1959
- CSWRI Avikanagar (Tonk) 1962
- NRC Camel Bikaner 1984
- CIAH Bikaner 1993; DRMR Bharatpur
- NRC Seed Spices Tabiji, Ajmer 2000

Credit & co-operatives

- RSCB Apex Bank, 1953, Jaipur
- Central Co-op Banks - district tier
- PACS / GSS - village tier
- RAJFED, CONFED, RCDF

Schemes & policies

- Kisan Kalyan Kosh 2020-21, Rs 1,000 cr
- Kisan Mitra Urja Yojana 2021
- Krishak Sathi Yojana 2019
- Agri-Export Promotion Policy 2019
- Mandi Act 1961; RSAMB 1974
- Organic Farming Policy 2017

Animal husbandry

- Wool 1st, 47.85% (BAHS 2025)
- Milk 2nd, 14.82% (BAHS 2025)
- Largest camel population
- Camel = state animal (domestic), 2014
- RCDF 1977 - SARAS brand

How much agriculture actually matters in Rajasthan

Start with the weight. Agriculture and allied activities give about a quarter of Rajasthan's value added but employ the largest share of its workforce. That mismatch is the whole story of the sector - many people, modest output per person, heavy dependence on rain. It is also why Rajasthan became the first state in India to present a separate agriculture budget.

- Agriculture and allied activities = about 25.7% of Rajasthan's GSVA (Rajasthan Economic Review 2025-26).
- The sector supports the largest share of the state's workforce - more people than any other sector. Nationally agriculture holds about 46% of workers (PLFS 2023-24) and Rajasthan's share is clearly higher.
- Foodgrain production 2025-26 estimated at 283.98 lakh tonnes (Economic Review 2025-26).
- Average operational landholding about 2.73 hectares - among the largest in India, because dryland farming needs area.
- Rajasthan's separate agriculture budget for 2026-27 is about Rs 1.19 lakh crore (Rs 1,19,408 crore).

The mismatch that defines Rajasthan's farm sector

Share of value added	Share of employment
About 25.7% of GSVA	The single largest employing sector
Falling slowly as services grow	Falls much more slowly
Output per worker is low	Underemployment is chronic
Rain-dependent, so it swings year to year	Employment stays put even in a bad year

- Economic Review 2025-26 also reports 2,000 natural farming clusters covering about 2.5 lakh farmers and 1 lakh hectares.
- Crop insurance claims of about Rs 6,206 crore were disbursed under PMFBY (Economic Review 2025-26).

- Rabi pulses grew 22.34% and kharif pulses 2.34% in 2025-26 (Economic Review 2025-26).

Land use, sown area and irrigation - the base numbers

Rajasthan is the largest state by area, so its absolute land figures are large even where percentages are ordinary. Two ratios matter for the exam. Net sown area is the land actually cropped in a year. Cropping intensity is gross cropped area divided by net sown area - it tells you how often the same field is used.

Land use pattern of Rajasthan, 2023-24 (Agricultural Statistics of Rajasthan 2023-24, Directorate of Economics & Statistics)

Item	Area / value	Share of reporting area
Reporting area	342.74 lakh hectares	100%
Net sown area	181.98 lakh hectares	53.10%
Gross cropped area	276.96 lakh hectares	-
Area sown more than once	94.98 lakh hectares	27.71%
Forest area	27.86 lakh hectares	8.13%
Culturable waste land	35.17 lakh hectares	10.26%
Cropping intensity	152.19	-

Now water. Rajasthan has about 1 per cent of India's surface water and irrigates mainly from below the ground. Wells and tube-wells - not canals - are the single largest source of irrigation in the state. The Indira Gandhi Nahar Pariyojana is the largest canal system, but 'largest source' and 'largest canal' are two different answers.

- Net irrigated area 95.47 lakh hectares = 52.46% of the net sown area (Agricultural Statistics of Rajasthan 2023-24).

- Gross irrigated area 129.60 lakh hectares; irrigation intensity 135.75.
- Wells and tube-wells are the largest source of irrigation in Rajasthan.
- The Indira Gandhi Nahar Pariyojana is the state's largest canal system.
- Budget 2026-27 targets micro-irrigation (drip and sprinkler) coverage of about 3 lakh hectares.
- Do not confuse the two intensities - cropping intensity (gross cropped / net sown) is about 152; irrigation intensity (gross irrigated / net irrigated) is about 136.

Now the zoning. For agricultural planning, Rajasthan is divided into TEN agro-climatic zones, numbered 1A to V and defined mainly by rainfall. Do not memorise all ten district lists. Memorise the count, the two extremes and the odd ones out. Zone 1C, the hyper-arid partial-irrigated zone of Bikaner, Jaisalmer and Churu, is the driest and the largest by area. Zone V, the humid south-eastern plain of Kota, Bundi, Baran and Jhalawar, is the wettest and the most productive - this is the Hadoti belt where soyabean, coriander and wheat come from. Zone 1B, the irrigated north-western plain of Sri Ganganagar and Hanumangarh, gets little rain but is the state's granary because the canals reach it.

The ten agro-climatic zones of Rajasthan (Department of Agriculture, Rajasthan)

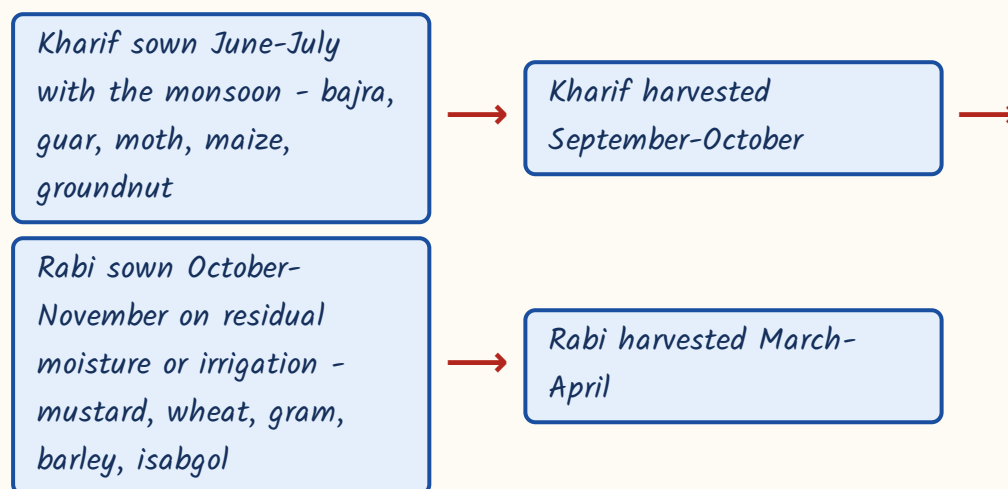
Zone	Name	Districts	Rainfall (mm)
1A	Arid Western Plain	Barmer, part of Jodhpur	200-370
1B	Irrigated North Western Plain	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh	100-350
1C	Hyper Arid Partial Irrigated Zone	Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Churu	100-350
IIA	Internal Drainage Dry Zone	Nagaur, Sikar, Jhunjhunu, part of Churu	300-500
IIB	Transitional Plain of Luni Basin	Jalore, Pali, Jodhpur, part of Sirohi	300-500

Zone	Name	Districts	Rainfall (mm)
IIIA	Semi-Arid Eastern Plain	Jaipur, Ajmer, Dausa, Tonk	500-700
IIIB	Flood Prone Eastern Plain	Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur, Karauli, Sawai Madhopur	500-700
IVA	Sub-Humid Southern Plain	Bhilwara, Chittorgarh, Udaipur, Sirohi	500-900
IVB	Humid Southern Plain	Banswara, Dungarpur, parts of Udaipur and Chittorgarh	500-1100
V	Humid South Eastern Plain	Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar	650-1000

The cropping pattern and the improved varieties

Rajasthan runs two main crop seasons. Kharif is the monsoon crop - bajra, guar, moth, maize, groundnut, cotton, soybean. Rabi is the winter crop - mustard, wheat, gram, barley, coriander, cumin, isabgol. Notice that Rajasthan's number-one crops sit in both seasons: bajra and guar in kharif, mustard and the seed spices in rabi.

The Rajasthan crop year



Improved varieties you are expected to recognise

Crop	Improved varieties
Bajra (pearl millet)	Raj-171, RHB-30, RCB-2, RCB-911, Pusa Composite 383, Moti, HB-3
Maize	Mahi Kanchan, Mahi Dhawal, Navjot, Megha, Moti Composite, Ganga-II

YAAD RAKHO

Variety mnemonic: anything starting with 'Mahi' is MAIZE - Mahi Kanchan, Mahi Dhawal. Anything with R-H-B or R-C-B or 'Raj-' is BAJRA. That one rule answers most variety questions, including the 'which is NOT a variety of bajra' form where Mahi Dhawal is the planted answer.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 - which of the following is a variety of maize developed for Rajasthan? Answer: Mahi Kanchan. The same list has since been recycled as a match-the-following between varieties and crops, and as a 'NOT a variety of bajra' question.

Where Rajasthan ranks in India - the table to memorise cold

This is the highest-yield block in the chapter. Learn the ranks that are solid and do not guess the ones that move. Rajasthan's number-one positions in bajra, mustard, guar, moth, isabgol, coriander, fenugreek, henna, taramira and total oilseeds are stable year after year. Groundnut second and soybean third are also stable. Everything else moves with the harvest.

Rajasthan at number ONE in India - crop, share and leading district

Crop	Share of national output	Leading district in Rajasthan
Bajra (pearl millet)	About 39%	Alwar (Barmer has the largest AREA under bajra)
Mustard / rapeseed	About 47%	Sri Ganganagar
Guar (cluster bean)	About 87%	Hanumangarh
Total oilseeds	About 22%	-
Moth bean	Largest producer	-
Isabgol (psyllium)	Largest producer	-
Coriander	Largest producer	Hadoti belt - Kota, Baran, Jhalawar, Bundi
Fenugreek (methi)	Largest producer	Nagaur
Henna (mehndi)	Largest producer	Sojat, Pali - India's henna capital
Taramira	Largest producer	-
Wool	47.85% (BAHS 2025)	-

Rank 2 and 3, and the districts that lead the remaining crops

Rank 2 and 3, and the rest of the leading-district map

Crop	Rajasthan's rank / position	Leading district
Groundnut	Second, after Gujarat	-
Soybean	Third, after Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra	-
Milk	Second, after Uttar Pradesh	-
Maize	-	Chittorgarh
Jowar	-	Ajmer
Cotton	-	Hanumangarh

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - Rajasthan's rank in India in bajra production.

Answer: first. The same paper carried a statement set combining bajra, mustard and guar leadership, and the answer was that all three statements are correct. If a statement set claims Rajasthan leads in bajra, mustard, guar and oilseeds, accept it.

TRAP

Two traps here, and RPSC uses both. First, do not upgrade a rank: Rajasthan is second in groundnut, third in soybean, second in milk - never first in any of these. Second, do not assert ranks that shift - gram, barley, cumin and opium positions move between Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat from harvest to harvest, so unless the question gives you a named source and year, treat those as uncertain rather than guessing 'first'.

The seed-spice belt and the crop-place map

Seed spices are the spices you harvest as a seed - coriander, cumin, fenugreek, fennel, ajwain, nigella. Rajasthan and Gujarat together are India's seed-spice bowl, and Rajasthan is the leader in coriander and fenugreek. The belt runs across the semi-arid districts: the Hadoti districts of Kota, Baran, Jhalawar and Bundi for coriander, and the western districts around Jodhpur, Nagaur, Pali and Jalore for cumin and fenugreek. That geography is why the National Research Centre on Seed Spices was placed at Tabiji in Ajmer.

Crop-place pairs that RPSC matches

Product	Place in Rajasthan
Henna (mehndi)	Sojat, Pali district - India's henna capital
Coriander	Ramganj Mandi, Kota - Asia's largest coriander market

Product	Place in Rajasthan
Red chilli	Mathania, Jodhpur
Fenugreek (methi)	Nagaur - 'Nagauri methi'
Oranges	Jhalawar
Opium	Chittorgarh and Pratapgarh
Mustard belt	Bharatpur

- *Isabgol is grown mainly in the western and southern districts and Rajasthan is India's largest producer.*
- *Guar is not just a food crop - guar gum from Rajasthan is a major industrial and export item.*
- *Rajasthan's opium is grown under licence in Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh and neighbouring tracts.*
- *The Agro-Processing, Agri-Business and Agri-Export Promotion Policy 2019 targets exactly these commercial crops.*

TRAP

Sojat and Ramganj Mandi get swapped every single year in student answers. Sojat is in PALI and it is henna. Ramganj Mandi is in KOTA and it is coriander. Also keep Mathania (Jodhpur, red chilli) apart from Nagaur (methi) - both are western districts and both are 'famous for' pairs.

The research institutes and the agricultural universities - a documented repeat

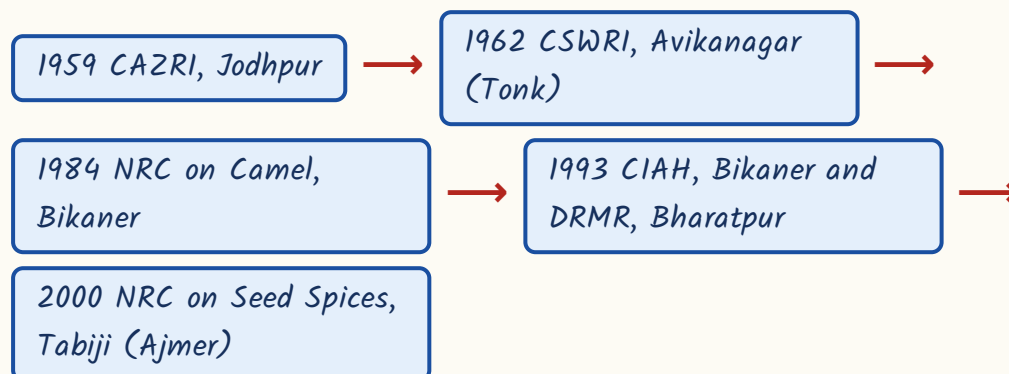
This is the single most repeated block in the chapter. RPSC asked the National Research Centres in Rajasthan in 2016, 2018 and 2023, in three different formats - direct location, match-the-following, and 'NOT correctly matched'.

Learn institute, place and year together. The years also give you chronological-ordering questions.

Agricultural research institutes in Rajasthan

Institute	Location	Established
CAZRI - Central Arid Zone Research Institute	Jodhpur	1959
CSWRI - Central Sheep and Wool Research Institute	Avikanagar, Malpura tehsil, Tonk	1962
National Research Centre on Camel	Bikaner	1984
CIAH - Central Institute for Arid Horticulture	Bikaner	1993
DRMR - Directorate of Rapeseed-Mustard Research	Bharatpur	1993 as NRC; Directorate in 2009
NRCSS - National Research Centre on Seed Spices	Tabiji, Ajmer	2000

Chronological order of the institutes - asked as an ordering question



The five agricultural universities

- SKRAU - Swami Keshwanand Rajasthan Agricultural University, Bikaner (1987).
- MPUAT - Maharana Pratap University of Agriculture and Technology, Udaipur (1999).

- The 2013 trio: Agriculture University Jodhpur, Agriculture University Kota, and Sri Karan Narendra Agriculture University, Jobner (Jaipur).
- So five agricultural universities in all - two older ones and three created together in 2013.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 and 2023 - the National Research Centre on Camel is in which district? Answer: Bikaner. Asked in 2018 and 2023 - the National Research Centre on Seed Spices is at Tabiji, Ajmer, and in the 'NOT correctly matched' form the planted wrong pair was 'Seed Spices - Bharatpur'. Asked in 2016 - the Central Institute for Arid Horticulture, answer Bikaner. Three papers, one cluster.

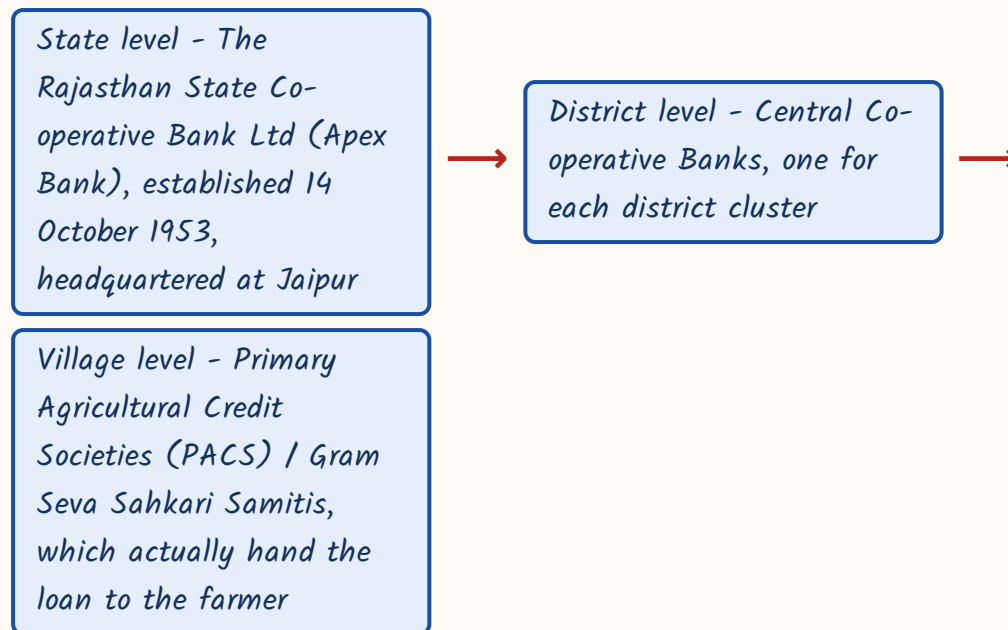
YAAD RAKHO

Two rules kill this whole block. One - BIKANER HAS TWO: Camel and Arid Horticulture. Two - the mustard institute is at Bharatpur and the spice institute is at Ajmer; if an option pairs seed spices with Bharatpur it is the wrong pair the examiner planted. Sheep and wool go to Avikanagar in Tonk, not to Bikaner, even though Bikaner is wool country.

Agricultural credit and the co-operative structure

A Rajasthani farmer's crop loan usually comes through a co-operative, not a commercial bank. The short-term co-operative credit system in Rajasthan is a three-tier pyramid - one apex bank at the state level, central co-operative banks at the district level, and primary societies in the villages. Learn the three tiers in order, because match-the-following works on the tiers.

The three-tier short-term co-operative credit structure



- Long-term credit runs on a separate track through land development banks - a state-level body and primary land development banks below it.
- Rajasthan's co-operative law is the Rajasthan Co-operative Societies Act, 2001.
- Interest-free short-term crop loans to farmers are routed through the PACS network by the co-operative department.
- The co-operative farm loan waiver - Rajasthan Krishak Rin Mafi Yojana - was announced in the 2018-19 budget and implemented from 2019.
- Scale, as of September 2026: about 29 central co-operative banks at the district tier, with several thousand PACS / Gram Seva Sahkari Samitis below them.
- Raj Sahkar is the state co-operative department's online portal for society registration and member services - remember it as the digital face of the co-operative system.

Apex co-operative bodies - one per sector, so match them by sector

Body	Sector it leads
RSCB (Apex Bank)	Short-term agricultural credit
RAJFED	Agricultural marketing

Body	Sector it leads
CONFED	Consumer stores
RCDF	Dairy - the SARAS brand

Mandis, marketing policy and the schemes for farmers

Once the crop is harvested it goes to a mandi. Rajasthan's mandi system runs under a 1961 Act and is supervised by a board created in 1974. Around that skeleton sit the policies and the cash schemes. RPSC asks the year, not the mechanics - so learn Act-and-year pairs.

- Rajasthan Agricultural Produce Markets Act, 1961 - the law governing the mandi system.
- Rajasthan State Agricultural Marketing Board (RSAMB) - constituted 1974.
- Rajasthan Agro-Processing, Agri-Business and Agri-Export Promotion Policy - notified 2019.
- Chronological order that has been asked: RSAMB 1974, then the Agri-Export Policy 2019 and Krishak Sathi Yojana 2019, then Kisan Kalyan Kosh 2020-21, then Kisan Mitra Urja Yojana 2021.

Farmer schemes of Rajasthan - year and the one feature that identifies it

Scheme	Year	Identifying feature
Mukhyamantri Krishak Sathi Yojana	2019	Compensation for accidental death or injury of farmers and mandi workers during agricultural work
Rajasthan Kisan Kalyan Kosh	2020-21 budget	Corpus of Rs 1,000 crore
Mukhyamantri Kisan Mitra Urja Yojana	2021	Electricity-bill subsidy up to Rs 1,000 a month, maximum Rs 12,000 a year, for metered agricultural consumers
Separate Agriculture Budget	2022-23	India's first; presented 23 February 2022

Horticulture and organic farming - the two missions

- Horticulture in Rajasthan is run by the Commissionerate of Horticulture and the Rajasthan Horticulture Development Society, which implement the centrally sponsored Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture (MIDH) in the state.
- The horticulture push is built around the state's own belts - kinnow in Sri Ganganagar and Hanumangarh, oranges in Jhalawar, aonla, ber and date palm in the arid districts, and vegetables in the peri-urban blocks.
- Protected cultivation (green houses, poly houses, shade nets) and drip-and-sprinkler micro-irrigation are the standard subsidy heads under MIDH.
- Rajasthan Organic Farming Policy - notified 2017. Its aim is to expand certified organic area, build a certification and marketing chain and cut chemical input dependence.
- Certification is done through accredited agencies; a Rajasthan state organic certification body operates alongside the national NPOP and PGS-India systems.
- Natural farming has been added on top - the Economic Review 2025-26 reports about 2,000 natural farming clusters covering roughly 2.5 lakh farmers and 1 lakh hectares.
- Exam angle: for horticulture and organic, RPSC asks the policy YEAR (2017) and the implementing body, not the acreage.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the Rajasthan agriculture budget for 2026-27 is about Rs 1,19,408 crore. Its stated targets include 50,000 solar pumps under PM-KUSUM and micro-irrigation coverage of about 3 lakh hectares, and the Co-operative Dairy Infrastructure Development Fund was doubled to Rs 2,000 crore. Budget-announcement matching is a standing RPSC current-affairs item, so revise these four numbers close to the exam.

ASKED IN RAS

The Kisan Mitra Urja Yojana ceiling has been asked directly - the maximum annual electricity-bill subsidy is Rs 12,000, which is Rs 1,000 a month. The Kisan Kalyan Kosh corpus of Rs 1,000 crore and the 2019 date of the Agri-Export Policy have both appeared in statement and matching form. Cash figure plus year - that is all these questions ever want.

Animal husbandry, wool, milk and fisheries

Livestock is the insurance policy of a Rajasthani farmer. When the monsoon fails, the animals still earn. That is why Rajasthan leads India in wool and sits second in milk, and why the camel matters enough to be the state animal.

Rajasthan in India's livestock economy (Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2025, reference year 2024-25)

Item	Rajasthan's position	National context
Wool	FIRST - 47.85% of national output	India's total wool output 34.57 million kg
Milk	SECOND - 14.82% of national output	Uttar Pradesh first at 15.66%; India's total 247.87 million tonnes
Camel population	Largest in India	Camel declared the state animal (domestic category) in 2014

- Nearly half of India's wool comes from Rajasthan - remember 47.85%, which rounds to about 48%.
- The milk gap is narrow: 15.66% for Uttar Pradesh against 14.82% for Rajasthan. Narrow, but Rajasthan is still second.
- CSWRI at Avikanagar (Tonk) is the national institute for sheep and wool research - it explains the wool leadership.

- RCDF - the Rajasthan Cooperative Dairy Federation, set up 1977 - markets milk and milk products under the SARAS brand.
- Milk unions sit under RCDF at the district level, on the standard Anand pattern.

TRAP

The most planted wrong option in this whole chapter is 'Rajasthan is India's largest producer of milk'. It is not. It is **FIRST** in wool and **SECOND** in milk. Say it as one line - 'wool first, milk second, camel most' - and you will never lose this mark. RCDF is also not the fisheries body; fisheries sit with the state fisheries department, not the dairy federation.

- Fisheries in Rajasthan are reservoir- and tank-based, not marine - the state has no coastline.
- The main fishing waters are the large reservoirs and lakes of the eastern and southern districts.
- Livestock insurance covered about 10.63 lakh animals in 2025-26 (Rajasthan Economic Review 2025-26).

REVISION RECAP

1. Agriculture and allied = about 25.7% of GSVA but the largest employing sector.
2. Foodgrain output 283.98 lakh tonnes, 2025-26 (Economic Review 2025-26).
3. Average operational holding about 2.73 hectares - among India's largest.
4. Net sown area 181.98 lakh ha = 53.10% of reporting area; cropping intensity 152.19 (2023-24).
5. Ten agro-climatic zones, IA to V - IC (Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Churu) driest; Zone V (Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar) wettest.
6. Wells and tube-wells are the largest irrigation source; IGNP is the largest canal system.
7. Number one in India: bajra ~39%, mustard ~47%, guar ~87%, total oilseeds ~22%.
8. Also number one: moth, isabgol, coriander, fenugreek, henna, taramira.
9. Second in groundnut (after Gujarat); third in soybean (after MP and Maharashtra).

10. Leading districts: bajra Alwar, mustard Sri Ganganagar, guar Hanumangarh, maize Chittorgarh, jowar Ajmer, cotton Hanumangarh.
11. Sojat (Pali) = henna capital; Ramganj Mandi (Kota) = Asia's largest coriander market.
12. Mathania red chilli, Nagauri methi, Jhalawar oranges, Chittorgarh-Pratapgarh opium.
13. Mahi = maize varieties; RHB / RCB / Raj = bajra varieties.
14. Institutes: CAZRI Jodhpur 1959, CSWRI Avikanagar (Tonk) 1962, NRC Camel Bikaner 1984, CIAH Bikaner 1993, NRC Seed Spices Tabiji (Ajmer) 2000, DRMR Bharatpur.
15. Five agricultural universities: Bikaner 1987, Udaipur 1999, and Jodhpur, Kota, Jobner in 2013.
16. Co-operative credit is three-tier: RSCB Apex Bank (1953, Jaipur), Central Co-op Banks, PACS.
17. Mandi Act 1961; RSAMB 1974; Agri-Export Promotion Policy 2019; Organic Farming Policy 2017.
18. Kisan Kalyan Kosh Rs 1,000 crore (2020-21); Kisan Mitra Urja max Rs 12,000 a year (2021).
19. Wool FIRST at 47.85%; milk SECOND at 14.82% behind UP's 15.66% (BAHS 2025).
20. RCDF (1977) sells under the SARAS brand; camel is the state animal since 2014.